Summary

- After Harsha, new regional powers emerged. Prominent ruling dynasties among them were Pratiharas, Palas, Chauhans and Paramaras.
- Pratiharas and Palas were battling to control the northern plains. Their focus was on capturing the city of Kanauj.
- The continued conflict over the possession of Kanauj prompted the local chieftains and kings to declare themselves independent.
- The Rajputs and Palas made impressive contribution to the evolving Indian culture.
- The attempts of Arabs to expand were resisted by various rulers.
- Military raids of Mahmud of Ghazni in the 11th century followed by expeditions of Muhammad of Ghor paved the way for the establishment of Islamic rule in India.

Glossary		
scion	a descendant of the notable family	வாரிசு, வழித்தோன்றல்
unprecedented	exceptional	முன்னெப்போதுமில்லாத
internecine	mutually destructive	இருசாராருக்கும் நாசத்தை விளைவிக்கின்ற
portraiture	the art of painting	சித்தரிக்கும் கலை
elegant	grand	நேர்த்தியான
monastery	a place where monks live	மடாலயம்
confederacy	a league or alliance of states	கூட்டமைப்பு

Evaluation

I. Choose the correct answer

1. Who wrote *Prithivirajraso?*

   a) Kalhana
   b) Vishakadatta
   c) Rajasekara
   d) Chand Bardai

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2. Who was the first prominent ruler of Pratiharas?

   a) Bhoja I b) Naga Bhatta I
   c) Jayapala d) Chandradeva

3. Ghazni was a small principality in _____

   a) Mangolia b) Turkey
   c) Persia d) Afghanistan

4. What was the most important cause of the invasion of Mahmud of Ghazni?

   a) To destroy idolatry
   b) To plunder the wealth of India
   c) To spread Islam in India
   d) To establish a Muslim state in India

II Fill in the blanks

1. _____ was the founder of Vikramashila University.
2. Arabs conquered Sind in _____.
3. The city of Ajmeer was founded by _____.
4. The Khandarya temple is in _____.

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